

ANI

Sarbananda Sonowal
Minister of AYUSH

Healthy Progress

Ayush remains close to the government's heart as it works towards reform in education and regulation

By Kaushik Deka

TRADITIONAL MEDICINE HAS long been regarded with scepticism than acceptance in India. Changing that dynamic was a Modi government priority from Day 1. A separate ministry for Ayurveda, Yoga and Naturopathy, Unani, Siddha and Homeopathy or AYUSH was made in 2014 and attention and funds have flowed freely since for the Sarbananda Sonowal-led ministry. Budgetary allocation has risen fivefold to Rs 3,647 crore this year from Rs 691 crore in 2014. Besides popularising traditional medicine, the ministry is trying to reform the education and regulatory architecture. An independent vertical under the Central Drugs Standard Control Organisation with nine regulatory posts has been set up to monitor the quality of Ayush drugs, in line with the provisions of the Drugs and Cosmetics Act, 1940. Collaborations with institutes like CSIR, CIMR and ILBS aim to find an integrative research model to generate scientific evidence for Ayush drugs. An Ayush startup scheme under the Ayush Vikas Yojana is on the anvil. The government's flagship insurance scheme Ayushman Bharat now includes Ayush Health and Wellness Centres (AHWCs) too. ■

BOLD & BRAVE

₹3,648 CRORE

Budget 2023 allocation for Ayush, an 88% jump from 2020

- **National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM) Act, 2020 passed**
- **Ayush products to be checked for quality**

BUT...

2%

Fall in no. of registered Ayush doctors in past five years